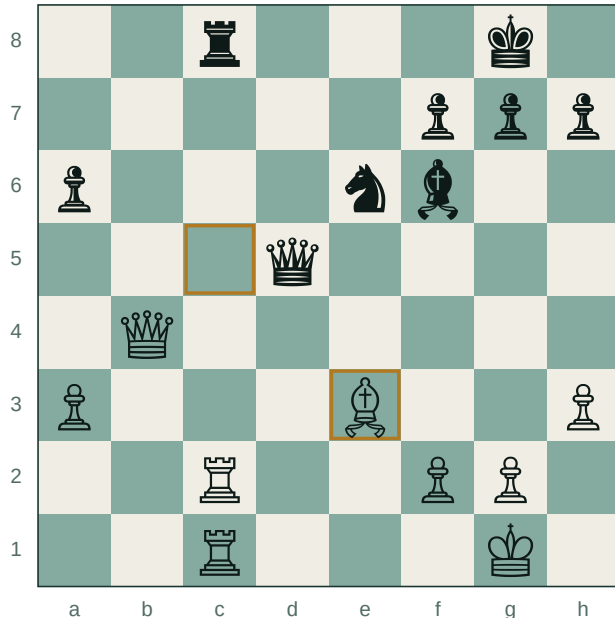


Attraction tactics: Black, move 30

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 30.Be3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30...Rxc2 31. Rxc2 Qd1+ 32. Kh2 Qxc2

30...Rxc2 The rook captures the rook on c2. Recorded reply: **31.Rxc2**.

31...Qd1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From d1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on c2. Recorded reply: **32.Kh2**.

32...Qxc2 The queen captures the rook on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.